

2.6 The Dodge And Burn Tool



These tools allow you to darken or lighten parts of an image. The Dodge tool makes the area where it is applied appear lighter, and conversely, the Burn tool makes the area appear darker. The Dodge and Burn tools are bundled in the same bin in the toolbox—just click on the button and hold it for the other tools to appear. For the Dodge and Burn tools, you can select the brush size you want, the range, the exposure and hardness. The greater the exposure and hardness is set to, the more pronounced the effect of the tool is.

For most practical purposes, you can set the Range to Midtones. Use the Shadows setting under the Range if you are trying to lighten darker areas in an attempt to remove them. As with other operations in Photoshop, if you are editing a large area, you can start off with a larger brush around the centre of your intended work area and then use the smaller brushes at the edges. Start with lower values of Hardness and Exposure and then work your way up—it is better to start off with lower values and see the changes in the image progressively rather than abruptly with a single high value.



The Brushes and Hardness Settings